CS 2A Syllabus - Winter 2022

Introduction to Object Oriented Programming in C++

Hey there. My name is Anand. Please read this syllabus carefully. You should especially read it if you have never taken a class from me before.

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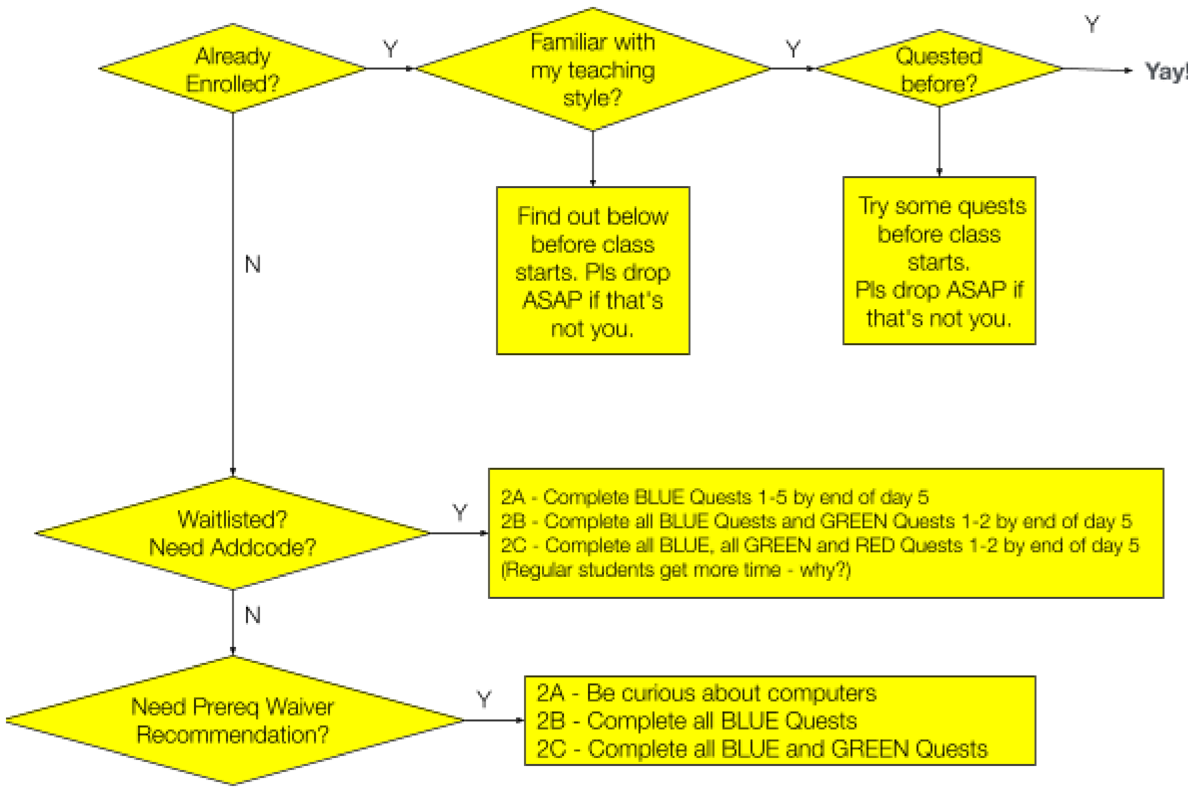
Jump To

Section I - First Things

First things first - Should you enroll?



Here is the way I approach teaching: I don't think I have ever been fond of stuffing knowledge down the throats of people who don't want it. So you shouldn't be in my CS **2B** class if you don't want CS at this time in your life. But how do you know if you want CS or not?

Well, you could try **this course - CS2A**. Chances are that it is your cup of tea and you want more of it, especially if you're curious, inquisitive and brilliant.

If you're doing the quests for your own edification at your own pace - awesome. That's the way to be. No fun being full of stress, either before your tests or during your quests.

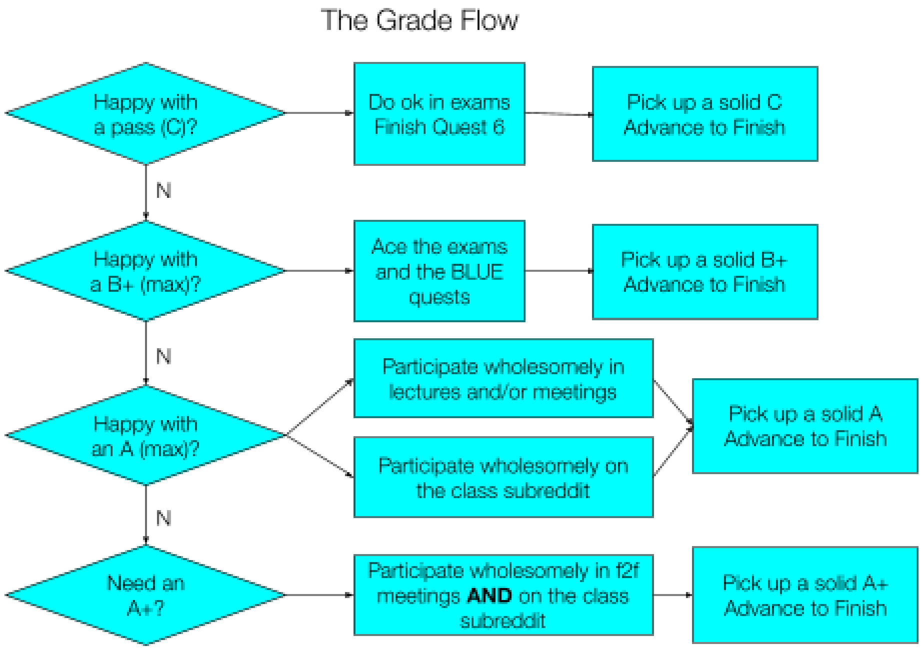
Note the following **essential** prerequisite skills.

- Looking up, evaluating, and using information on the net
- Following simple directions correctly (e.g. creating a subreddit user according to some requirements)

If you don't have these skills yet, take some time to learn them first (usually, quite easy) and then enroll.

In my classes, you will largely self-teach yourself most of the material with help from us and your classmates. Your tutors and I will be watching, careful not to step in and give you the answer. Yes - You will NOT be given the answer. You cannot ask anyone to debug your programs for you. You have to find it yourself, although we will give you all the help we think you need.

First Things Second - General Matters



YES! Whether you're doing this class to just get a feel for this thing called C++, whether you want to be good at it, but not necessarily make it the center of your programming world, or whether you want to learn from this class and prepare to dive into the depths of CS and swim with the sharks… this class has a track for you.

If you just want a smattering of programming knowledge in C++, you should complete quests 1-6, and do ok in the quizzes and exams. No need to participate in the forums. You'll get your passing grade.

For a B+, you should do well in your quizzes and exams, and also complete all 9 quests, without necessarily acing anything.

To get to A Territory, you absolutely need to earn participation points, which you can assume to be a proxy for evidence of productive collaborative programming, which is an important skill to have in the real world. Section III in this syllabus shows you how to get them.

Important Note: *I try to keep everything public, including 1-1 meetings you may have with me unless it involves confidential matters. Any class-related discussion that may be generally useful will be made available as transcripts or recordings at publicly accessible media sites (e.g. YouTube or Reddit). Make sure you are ok with this policy before enrolling.*

Section II - Administrative stuff

CS 2A is an introduction to object-oriented programming using the C++ language. Absolute beginners or students already familiar with other programming languages will learn how to write C++ programs that cover a wide range of applications. The ability to work with computers and access to the internet are the only prerequisites.[1]

A working facility with simple algebra and good written English comprehension skills are both strong advisories.

Course outline and SLOs

You can access the official course outline of record for all CS courses here. Student Learning Outcomes for this course are:

1. A successful student will be able to write and debug C++ programs which make use of the fundamental control structures and method-building techniques common to all programming languages. Specifically, the student will use data types, input, output, iterative, conditional, and functional components of the language in his or her programs.
2. A successful student will be able to use object-oriented programming techniques to design and implement a clear, well-structured C++ program. Specifically, the student will use and design classes and objects in his or her programs.

By enrolling in this course in **Winter 2022**, you are implicitly agreeing that this syllabus provides a bare minimum of what you may experience during a one-quarter run of this class. However, experimental variations may gradually be introduced on a per section basis. You agree to be part of these too and to meet reasonable (as determined by me) additional flexible learning requirements that may be incorporated into this class before the finals (totals may be scaled appropriately if you're doing it for a grade).

Are there lectures?

For CS2A, I offer both pure virtual and synchronous classes whenever possible. Synchronous may be either face to face on campus, or via zoom..

CS2A students who are enrolled in a sync section can earn half (7.5) of a total of 15 participation points by attending class *actively*, especially if you get an opportunity to *live-code* in class.

Want to see other students live-coding in action? Check out our past recordings. I made a list (about 3 quarters of CS2A classes) at:

https://www.reddit.com/r/cs2a/comments/o2vpki/complete_list_of_recorded_classes

[1] However, DO NOT EXPECT spoon-feeding. *You will not get answers in this class.* Just expect to be taught ways to find the answers yourself. If you expect to get answers to your questions, you will be disappointed with this class and your grade if you continue in it. Check the subreddit where students have been very vocal about this rule.

Canvas

Canvas is our hub to coordinate some activities and take online exams. Most of the rest of our work will happen at other public locations, including youtube, zoom, quests, reddit, etc. You will start your adventure in Foothill's class by completing the following **required** tasks.

1. posting an introductory note about yourself in Canvas. You can simply reply to my own introductory post if you prefer, and
2. scoring at least 90% on the syllabus quiz (in Canvas). This doesn't need knowledge of CS or c++.

These must be completed before the end of the first Friday of the quarter to prevent your enrollment being reassigned to someone else on the waiting list.

Assessment

If you're doing this course for kicks, or other fun reasons, you can skip this section.

If this course is offered for a grade, and you are taking it for a grade, then, I will determine your final grade with the absolute grading scale below:

For an	A+	A	A-	B+	B	B-	C+	C	D	F
You need (%)	97	91	88	86	80	78	75	67	60	< 60

The assessment has been designed to test both conceptual understanding and knowledge of practical issues. The quests emphasize the latter and the exams/quizzes emphasize the former. The idea is that you should be able to get a passing grade by doing well in the quests and moderately well in everything else, but in order to get into A-grade territory, you have to demonstrate a solid grasp of the concepts and good class citizenship[2]. An A+ is possible if you truly enjoy programming, program in your spare time for fun, and take the trouble to independently look up, discuss (in the forums) and learn topics I will announce from time to time in announcements.

With that said, if you're focused solely on your grade and do everything flawlessly by the book, but fail to demonstrate good conceptual understanding, you will likely not get an A in this course.

In this course there will be:

- One syllabus quiz (worth 1%)
- One data representation quiz (worth 4%)
- 9 Mystery Quests you will solve at the rate of about one per week. These quests need to be solved using C++ (worth 60%)
- 1 Midterm and 1 Final exam (worth 20%)
- Participation in discussion forums and f2f meetings (incl. lecture) (worth 15%)

[2] "*How does good class citizenship contribute to learning?*" you ask. Good question. I'm using it as a suitably weighted proxy for confidence in a person's conceptual knowledge. In the past, I noticed a good correlation between a person's understanding of a concept and their willingness to explain it to someone else.

Exams

You will have one midterm exam on the Thu of Week 6 (Feb 10) and one final exam on the Thu of Week 12 (Mar 24). The midterm is worth 20 points and the final 40. Together, their combined score will be scaled from 60 to 20%.

These exams are objective style and will be administered via Canvas. You will typically have a window of time (18+ hours) during which you can begin these exams. But once you begin, the current version of Canvas does not allow you to *pause* your exam and come back to it. The 1h (or 2h for final) timer cannot be stopped once you start it, until you hit finish.

All exams are open-book and can be taken anywhere you get a decent Internet connection. I don't recommend taking them on mobile devices.

Nobody can prevent determined cheaters from cheating. But keep in mind that cheaters only cheat themselves. Copying is a waste of your time. Few good software companies employ programmers based upon their qualifications if their demonstrated competence doesn't measure up to their stated expertise.Besides, you'll find that copying robs you of a great opportunity to really learn the language and have a load of fun.

Mystery Quests (capped at **180** for CS2A this quarter)

You will solve these at the public questing site (https://quests.nonlinearmedia.org).

Each quest will give you a certain number of trophies. You can check your total trophy count at any time by visiting your personal scoreboard at the /q site (It will be wiped on the 1st of Jan, Apr, Jul, and Oct). *It will show you all your trophies, but only the ones you earned for 2A (BLUE ones) count for this course*. Your secret handle is your Student ID

The quests are set up such that the password to each quest is given out upon scoring a certain number of trophies in the preceding quest. However, I found that a few students were getting stuck in the lower numbered quests pounding away at them to eke out every remaining trophy before moving on, even though they had already earned the password. This is a bad strategy. Keep moving when you get a password. You can always come back to polish your previous quests when you have free time before the freeze date. You get about ONE week (7 days) before each quest freezes.

At the end of the quarter, your total trophy count will be capped at **180** and scaled from **180** to 60%. If you spend a lot of effort getting up to high numbers by the time you get to Quest 7 already, then you'll be close to getting burned out right in time for two of the funnest quests of all. So plan your time and effort wisely. It's not like your old quests are going to disappear when you move on.

What is a Quest Freeze?

A freeze is when I will review your submissions and transfer scores from a particular quest into Canvas.

If a quest has frozen, you still have to complete it in order to move forward into the next quest, but your trophies for it will not be counted towards your grade!

Bummer… Yes? If I were you I would try my best to avoid that situation by staying on top of things and taking this class ***seriously***.

However: There is one glimmer of hope if you missed a freeze deadline. You can plow through and complete Quest 9, earning the password for the first GREEN quest. Then all quests automatically become unfrozen, and all points, including for your frozen quests, will get transferred to Canvas towards your grade.

Getting started on your mystery trail

Discover the password to the first quest, or ask someone nicely.

Passwords for subsequent quests will be automatically revealed upon *satisfactory progress* (as the machine sees it) in each preceding quest.

In order for rewards from a quest to count towards your total, you must have completed all previous quests. If you leave a hole in your trail of completed quests, then your total reward earnings is the sum of all rewards you earned before the first incomplete quest.

You can quest as much as you want. Everything you do is logged. Quest with your ID and we can watch your struggles, progress, and know when it is best to help.

Bugs in your code?

Getting your code debugged by someone else is NOT allowed. That includes me, tutors, teachers, friends, enemies and relatives. Debugging your own code is an essential skill that aspiring programmers must learn and enjoy - Yes, enjoy!

Of course, I can't police this. But your enrollment in this class signifies acceptance of this condition (in addition to being bound by Foothill's Academic Integrity Policy). You cannot send your code to me, a tutor, or someone else and ask them what the issue is. What you can do is:

1. Explain (in our **subreddit**) what you're trying to do
2. Describe in English the steps you think might work, or if you have no idea and would like someone to explain the requirement better.
3. Or describe the behavior of your program and ask why it is not working as expected.

Sometimes it is also ok to post your code on our **subreddit**. Mostly, exercise good judgment regarding what can be shared. You want a fun and fulfilling learning experience. The best way to get it is to keep it fun and fulfilling for everyone. You wouldn't give away a movie's ending to a friend who's going to watch it. Why give them the solution to a problem when they can feel good finding it themselves?

Grinding?

I define *grinding* as many rapid submissions to the questing site without much thought going into exactly what change you're making to your code or why, in the blind hope it would work. It is like spraying bullets in the dark hoping one of them will hit your target. If this tendency is not nipped early, it will not make for a successful builder of anything, let alone programs.

It does not matter if you're *grinding* in anonymous mode without a Student ID. The system can flag your code if it suspects grinding behavior or code similar to any code that was *ground*. In that case, your participation points will take a serious hit and you may not know.

A Questing Tip: One way to boost the likelihood of getting participation points is to quest in non-anonymous mode with your Student ID. Your increasingly successful attempts will be better evidence of concept mastery than a sudden, non-anonymous, but successful solution, such as you can buy online.

Extensions

Extensions don't make sense because the quests are self-paced. You just have to complete each by their "freeze" date to get credit. After their freeze dates, you should still complete them, but not for credit. There's a LOT of time to complete these quests even if you have to take some breaks. So, there is no need to ask for extensions.

Programming style and compilers

My personal preference for program formatting is the C++ equivalent of the classic K&R style for C. It's not imperative that you follow the K&R style. I'm ok with any consistent and clean styling/formatting of your programs.

Use an IDE/compiler of your choice. But you'll find better support from me and the STEM center if you stick to one of the environments we know about (ask).

Suggested Schedule

Programming, like all art, is not a 9-5 job. Sometimes you're on a roll and killing it. Other times, not so much. I know how it is.

So there are no regular papers or labs due every day or week in this course. Rather, like real projects, there are deadlines you should strive to meet. You can plan your own time in your own way. Here is one suggestion:

Week	Read References	Complete	Notes
1	Data Representation Quiz (on Canvas)	Quiz	
	Vars, Exprs, Streams	Mystery Quest 1	
3	Control Structures	Mystery Quest 2	Q1 Freezes (Mon AM)
	Functions, Param passing	Mystery Quest 3	Q2 Freezes (Mon AM)
5	Arrays and Vectors	Mystery Quest 4	Q3 Freezes (Mon AM)
	Review/Midterm (on Canvas)	Mystery Quest 5	Q4 Freezes (Mon AM)
7	Objects, Classes	Mystery Quest 6	Q5 Freezes (Mon AM)
	Methods & Params	Mystery Quest 7	Q6 Freezes (Mon AM)
9	Pointers, Mem Mgmt.	Mystery Quest 8	Q7 Freezes (Mon AM)
	Algorithms, Searching	Mystery Quest 9	Q8 Freezes (Mon AM)
11	Sorting		Q9 Freezes (Mon AM)
	Final Exam (on Canvas)		

Col 2 is also the order in which the topics will be covered in lectures (for sync classes)

Every week, give yourself one or more topics to study and one or more programming quests to complete. If you have some programming experience already, expect to spend about 8-12 hours per week reading and/or attending lectures or watching videos. Budget an additional 10-15 hours for working on programming quests. To be on the safe side, budget about 25 hours per week (initially) for this course. Many students have underestimated the time required.

Office Hours

One time I happened to be in my office at 2AM. Someone knocked on my door.

> "Who is it?" I asked.
>
> "Quick question prof" said a female voice.
>
> I opened the door. "Hey sorry. My office hours are at 10am. See the sign?" I pointed at the print out I had stuck to my door. It clearly said 10AM - 11AM in **BIG BOLD BLACK** letters.
>
> "Yeah" she said. "I read it. But I'm a binary janitor. So I waited up until now to come here."
>
> "That's cool. You definitely deserve an answer" I said. "What's your question?"
>
> "Would you like me to come back later to empty your trash can?"

This quarter, I've decided to do away with this confusion. I have open office hours ANYTIME. I am very flexible in being able to adjust to your availability. But you have to pre-arrange it with me via email first.

I will likely be able to point you in the right direction for further experimentation. But I will not look at your questing code directly, nor debug it for you. Nor can you ask anyone else to do it (honor policy).

Don't be an *unceremonious drop*

An unceremonious drop is when a student enrolls in a class, discovers they are out of their depth, and decides to silently exit the class without telling or thanking anyone. This helps no one, especially those in the waitlist who might have got into class if you had not enrolled.

Get a taste of how this challenging class will be by reading this syllabus and checking out the comments left by past students on our subreddit (They usually have titles like "Tips" or "Advice" for future students).

For most people, CS2A is NOT challenging even if you are not interested in computer science.

CS2B requires active interest in the subject and a desire to spend your spare time coding. All others will find CS2B moderately challenging.

CS2C requires more than an active interest in the subject. You must be passionate about computers, logical problem solving, critical thinking and programming, and be keen to learn as many new tricks as possible. CS2C will be easy for such students, but VERY challenging for all others, regardless of where and how long you have been programming in your life.

Recommendations

I don't write or make comparative recommendations for students, nor provide my opinion or evaluation of your current or future abilities. I do not share the grade you earned in my classes. However, I can help you help yourself by giving you the chance to point admissions officers or hiring managers at your work (e.g. your reddit posts or live-coding videos on yt).

Section III - Participation Points

This is worth a whopping 15%. To put it in perspective, imagine that you were taking this course for a grade.

If you do everything else flawlessly, except participating in the online class, then you can get a maximum of 85 points. It translates to a grade of B+.

To make it into A territory, you not only have to be good at what you do, but must be able to explain concepts to others in your own words. The participation score is a confidential number I keep in my own spreadsheet by continuously monitoring the discussion forums and estimating how helpful, informative and/or encouraging each participant is. If you don't show up here, you are not deemed a participant.

How to get participation points

- Participate *wholesomely* in f2f class lectures (when offered) AND
- Participate *wholesomely* in the **class discussion forums on reddit**

Here is the participation points expiry schedule:

Week	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
Points	1.5		1.5	1.5	1.5	1.5	1.5	1.5	1.5	1.5	1.5	

- Up to a MAXIMUM of 1.5 points can be earned each week
- Weeks 1 and 12 are freebie weeks
- You cannot recover *expired* points from a previous week
- Points will be awarded and recorded in my secret spreadsheet for (a) lecture or meeting participation (50%) and (b) forum participation (50%).
- You will not know how many points you are getting and can only *infer it* from your final grade when Foothill eventually releases them to you. You cannot ask for a breakdown of your totals.

What constitutes wholesome participation? It is when you are both a giver and a receiver. You not only ask questions, but also provide answers, courteous help, and useful directions without compromising your classmates' pleasure of finding out for themselves.

There is a subjective component to the collaboration points. By signing up to this course you agree that you accept my subjective evaluation of your collaborative input to award suitably normalized collaboration points towards your final grade. You will not know exactly how much it is. So please don't ask me.

Wholesome f2f class participation is when all of the following conditions are met:

1. You are present during class
2. You ask interesting questions
3. Your camera is switched on and you are "live" on it (ok to switch off for short breaks) - if virtual
4. You volunteer to drive or co-drive during at least one class (see past lectures on our youtube channel to find out what this means; may not always get a chance)

Wholesome forum participation, which can be in addition to class participation, is when your contribution to the **publicly viewable** forum discussions are constructive, productive, and encouraging for those who are trying hard. To be on the safe side, consider adapting one of the templates in the next section for your subreddit posts (customize as necessary).

ANY user anywhere in the world can quest and post/discuss in our subreddits. So you may see posts and replies by users with anonymous names like *coding_lion*, *bat_girl* and such. All posts are subject to the same rules like *Johnny be good*, but only the ones with avatar names matching the spec in this syllabus will get participation credit: Your reddit avatar name **must** start with your first name (as on Canvas) and an underscore, followed by your initial (or full last name) + some optional digits (example: *ramanujan_s1729*).

Strong recommendations for our subreddit posts

1. No matter what your avatar's name, you must sign your posts with your first name (I strongly discourage unsigned posts. A reply should be able to start with something like "Hi John"
2. You should never post your student ID (CWID) online. A lot of personal information about you can be unlocked by someone who has it.
3. If you have something negative to say about someone's post in the forums, you should direct your concern to me, not to the person in the forum.
4. KEEP IN MIND that these discussion posts will persist into the next quarter and later for future students. So everything helpful you say will help far more students than just your current classmates.

Don't say anything in the forums that you'll end up regretting later in your life. OTOH do try to let your natural genuine curiosity shine through for others to seek out in a sea of wannabe programmers. Maintain your profile on our subs as you would if you were a professional and it will free up a lot of your time.

I will try to remove posts that I deem (in my subjective opinion) to be a liability to your future self. But you can't rely on it. Best to be helpful, courteous, informative and only post useful tips, tricks and observations. They usually have more lasting value.

Here is a useful strategy for those shooting beyond B+: Don't look up a solution on the sub until you have given it one whole mind-week (7 mind-days) of effort. Always try to solve it yourself. If and when you have to hit the sub before your 7-day waiting period, do it to ask a fresh new question in your own words, describing your particular problem. Only refer to past subreddit posts in answers to someone else's question (or other kinds of posts, like psas).

Watch this video: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=q3RF7TkW9ac&t=2405s

Even if you are asking a question that has been asked many times before, you can still get participation points if you demonstrate a good understanding of the material in the process of asking your question.

If you are making a post and not a comment, you can lock in your forum points for the week by making a post that generates 10+ comments OR inspires at least 1 insightful comment.

Finally, note that publishing a *good quality* tip sheet in your own style for a quest (look up the subs for examples) pretty much guarantees maxing out on the forum points for that week. But make sure the tip sheet is for the quest that everyone is supposed to be working on at that time. *Good quality = plenty of hints but NO answers.*

There will even be a surprise basket of significant *wild-card* extra credit points at the end of the quarter for a Tip-Sheet Popularity Contest. *Wild-card* points will be added to your total FINAL score out of 100.

Note that any posts or comments you make outside of a regular semester will also count towards your grade.

Templates 4U

Of course, you don't have to use the exact same words as these templates. Say it however you want. They just show you the critically required elements of your posts and/or comments.

Template 1 (Asking a question)

Use something like the following template to ask questions. Don't refer to previous posts on the subreddit unless you're answering someone else's question.

> Hiya folks,
>
> I was trying to access XYZ in ABC in this quest, and kept getting my donkey bitten.
>
> I suspect that it's because of UVW. I tried to check by doing MNO, but it OMG.
>
> Help please?
>
> - eternally_grateful_all_of_this_year

Template 2 (Giving an answer)

Use something like the following template to answer someone else's question. You can refer to past posts and comments here. You can post your answer *even if someone else has already posted one* as long as it is not the same perspective on the same answer.

> Hey eternally,
>
> I feel your pain. Have you tried IDK? Maybe share a screenshot of your error (without the password) and I can help better?
>
> From what you describe, it seems like you're having the same issue as this poster here:
>
> [Link(s) to past reddit posts]
>
> What's going on is that MNO goes out of bounds in the array when you use the -- operator on a size_t. I hope this helps.
>
> Let us know,
>
> - always_glad_to_help_today_0405.

Whether you're asking or answering, it's perfectly acceptable to say "*I tried u/XYZ's solution at [link to post] and it worked for me. My understanding of it is ABC. Happy to receive more light on this topic from someone who understands it better.*"

Template 3 (General Banter)

Use something like the following template to share your wonder. You may refer to past and external posts freely here.

> Hello,
>
> Recently I was browsing past reddit posts, waiting for the next Black Mirror episode, and came across this incredibly helpful observation by a past student (u/UVW).
>
> When we pop an item off the stack in Quest 8, we don't return it to the caller. Instead we destroy it. Ever wonder why? Well I did.
>
> The reason has to do with: ABCDE...
>
> I hope you are as surprised as I was when I learned it.
>
> Check it out: [Links to past and other external posts]
>
> - ever_curious_at_this_moment_00

Template 4 (Initiating discussion about something in a f2f class)

Use something like the following template to post something about the content for that week from previous lectures and external sources.

> Hello questers,
>
> This week we were supposed to play around with the topics - BCE and CED. These topics are discussed in the Week N youtube videos of past quarter recordings.
>
> 1. https://youtube.com/[nonlinearmedia channel]/... watch?v=ABCDE&t=34m23s (from Winter 2021)
> 2. https://youtube.com/[nonlinearmedia channel]/... watch?v=ABCDE&t=34m23s (from Spring 2020)
> 3. https://youtube.com/[somewhere else]/... watch?v=ABCDE&t=42m3s
>
> So I can understand why we say "EFG" whenever we check for "PQR", but it seems to contradict the other video (#3) from XYZ.edu. In fact, later in video #2 (around 43m) it seems to contradict what it said earlier at 34m23s.
>
> Anyone care to shed more light on this?
>
> - bored_with_linear_content

Refer to past questers whenever possible (and not asking a question). You can credit them by tagging their username in addition to sharing their link. Giving credit to others enhances your likelihood of getting participation points.

Common issues in getting participation points

"I found the answers to my issues in the subreddit. So I didn't have to post for the answer."

Of course you found the answer there. I'd be surprised if you didn't. Unfortunately, that means that you didn't struggle to find it yourself. Using help from past questers without overtly acknowledging them may not be a nice thing to do, but it certainly won't get you any collaboration points.

By doing this you're implicitly suggesting to me that you're driving in the B+ lane. You can switch lanes, but it is difficult to switch into a faster lane unless you've been driving as fast for a little while before the lane change.

"I'm uncomfortable with showing my face on published videos of our class lectures (and so my camera has to be off)"

It's perfectly fine as long as you tell me beforehand and we arrange for a suitable alternate way to establish your active presence. Otherwise, *enrolling in this class is implicit permission to publish videos in which you may appear as a student*.

Why not turn this to your advantage and make it a bullet in your portfolio. E.g.

- …
- Youtube link in which I coded live - [link to vid]
- …

Section IV - Resources

Check [this complete list of recorded CS2A lectures] with student participation (from about 3 previous quarters). See yourself in the shoes of one of your seniors. Ask for valuable live-coding opportunities in class (when available).

The book *Absolute **C++*** (any edition at least as recent as the 2nd), by Walter Savitch, Addison Wesley, is also a good choice. You can order it through our bookstore. But I recommend that you pick up a free or cheap online copy. Ask in the subreddit for help. Or simply email a request to the author himself.

Finally, I have a fork of CS2A/B/C modules that ex-prof Michael Loceff created when he taught this course. Thanks to Michael, I'm able to make these available to everyone completely free. Click on the appropriate link below to access them:

- https://quests.nonlinearmedia.org/foothill/loceff/cs2a
- https://quests.nonlinearmedia.org/foothill/loceff/cs2b
- https://quests.nonlinearmedia.org/foothill/loceff/cs2c

Although a couple of revisions behind, much of it is still relevant to this course. It is essentially a *distillation* of selected topics from the text. But be aware of salient differences between the content of his modules (or the text) and what some of our quests require. This shouldn't be a problem if you understand the concepts. But it will be a problem if you don't.

As always, hit our **sub**, when in doubt.

Actually, that's not quite it.

When in doubt, try it out.

If you still just don't get it. Then hit our **subreddit**.

Other Resources

The department maintains a blog called Opportunities for CS students. It has announcements of internships, scholarships, free software offers, public lectures, etc.

Lane's Lane

The Foothill STEM Center already provides fantastic assistance by making experienced CS tutors available for 1-1 real-time (synchronous) assistance almost 24/7 (via zoom) and generous hours in the STEM Center when the campus is open. Within the STEM Center, Lane Johnson hosts two special workshops each week focused especially on helping questers. Look for their actual hours on our sub, or simply check into the STEM Center sometime and ask for Lane.

Communication

Please use our **sub** for any question or comment that relates to the quests (except questions of a private nature). If you have a confidential question (grades or registration) you can email me. If you have a question that only makes sense of material you can find in Canvas (e.g. modules, syllabus, exams, etc.) then it makes sense to post that question in Canvas rather than our **sub**.

Try to meet with each other after class (even if virtually), set up private study and programming groups and work on independent (non assignment) programming challenges outside of class. I'll give you a few interesting challenges from time to time. Some of these may earn you extra credit.

You can reach me via messaging in Canvas, Reddit or by email. While on campus, my room number is `0x113d` (in hex). In week 1, you will learn how to decode that into decimal.

Disability Resource Center

Foothill College is committed to providing equitable access to learning opportunities for all students. Disability Resource Center (DRC) is the campus office that collaborates with students who have disabilities to provide and/or arrange reasonable accommodations.

If you have, or think you have, a disability in any area such as mental health, attention, learning, chronic health, sensory, or physical, please contact DRC to arrange a confidential discussion regarding equitable access and reasonable accommodations.

If you are registered with DRC and have a disability accommodation letter of accommodations set by a DRC counselor for this quarter, please use Clockwork to send your accommodation letter to your instructor and contact your instructor early in the quarter to review how the accommodations will be applied in the course.

Students who need accommodated test proctoring must contact the DRC immediately if they cannot find or utilize your MyPortal Clockwork Portal. DRC strives to provide accommodations in a reasonable and timely manner. Some accommodations may take additional time to arrange. We encourage you to work with DRC and your faculty as early in the quarter as possible so that we may ensure that your learning experience is accessible and successful.

To obtain disability-related accommodations, students must contact the Disability Resource Center (DRC) as early as possible in the quarter. To contact DRC, you may:

Visit DRC in Building 5400, Student Resource Center (physical visits suspended during college closure).

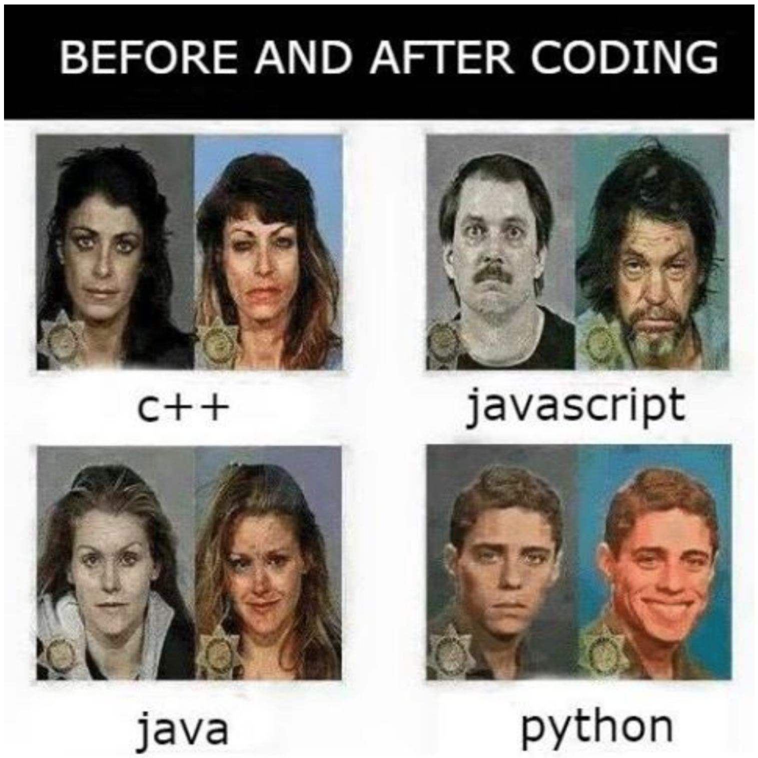
- On the web: http://www.foothill.edu/drc/
- Email DRC at drc@foothill.edu
- Call DRC at 650-949-7017 to make an appointment

Important Dates

For a list of important dates for the **winter** quarter, see [the official college page here].

Now smile, and get ready to get wasted (in a good way).

I found this on the net.



Bottom line

Computer science is a **hard science**, not a soft science. A significant investment of your time and effort will be required in this class.

Happy Hacking!

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